

Luckily, Hades' wife, Persephone, was touched by Orpheus's love for Eurydice. "Can't you see how much he loves her?" she said. "And haven't you heard his music? It's heartbreaking."

Hades was persuaded by his wife. "Leave the underworld," he told Orpheus, "and I will allow Eurydice to follow you. There is just one rule, however: you must not turn around to look at her until you have reached the world above."

*Orpheus set off back toward the land of the living, and Eurydice followed him.*

At first, Orpheus was overjoyed, but the longer he walked, the more he started to doubt Hades. "What if this is a trick?" he thought. "Or what if Eurydice has lost her way?" As he neared the gates that led out of the underworld, Orpheus could not stop himself from sneaking a glance over his shoulder. There was Eurydice in all her beauty! In a second, however, she had vanished.

Orpheus had failed to follow Hades' instructions, and Eurydice was gone forever. Orpheus was dismayed. His only comfort was that when his own time came to enter the underworld, he would be united with his wife again.

*When Orpheus turned to look at Eurydice, she disappeared.*